

2/21/2025 via FDMS

Raza Ali

Subject: AI Action Plan – Advancing AI Education for K-12 and Higher Education Dear OSTP and NITRD NCO: My name is Raza Ali, and I am writing to emphasize the importance of integrating AI education across both K-12 and higher education in a way that strengthens American innovation while ensuring students develop critical thinking and problem-solving skills. AI is already reshaping industries, and if the United States is to maintain its leadership in this field, our education system must prepare students not only to use AI tools effectively but also to understand their limitations, biases, and broader societal impact. As a student in the higher education system, I have seen how AI-powered tools can enhance learning and research in profound ways. However, as AI tools become more sophisticated, there is a growing concern that over-reliance on them could hinder students' ability to think independently and solve problems creatively. To prevent this, the AI Action Plan should include policies that ensure AI education enhances—rather than replaces—critical thinking skills at all levels of learning. I propose the following:

1. **AI Literacy Across All Grade Levels**
K-12 and higher education institutions should integrate AI education into their curricula, not just as a technical subject for computer science students but as a fundamental skill for all learners. This should include:
 - K-12: Basic AI concepts introduced early, focusing on responsible AI usage, understanding AI-generated content, and recognizing bias in machine learning models.
 - Higher Education: More advanced AI literacy, including hands-on applications in research, industry, and ethical considerations of AI deployment.
2. **AI as a Tool for Learning, Not a Substitute for Thinking**
AI should be integrated into education as a complement to human intelligence, not as a crutch that diminishes analytical skills. AI-powered learning tools should:
 - Provide students with data-driven insights while requiring them to interpret, analyze, and verify AI-generated outputs.
 - Encourage problem-solving exercises where students use AI to assist in brainstorming or research but must ultimately produce their own conclusions and arguments.
 - Teach students to critically evaluate AI responses rather than accepting them at face value, ensuring they develop the ability to fact-check and challenge AI-generated content.
3. **Teacher and Faculty Training in AI Integration**
Educators at both K-12 and higher education institutions need professional development opportunities to effectively incorporate AI into their teaching methods. Training programs should focus on:
 - Helping teachers balance AI use with traditional learning methods.
 - Encouraging faculty in higher education to integrate AI into research and coursework while maintaining academic integrity.
 - Providing clear guidelines on when and how AI tools should be used in assessments and assignments to avoid over-reliance.
4. **Ethical AI Education and Awareness**
With the rapid deployment of AI, it is critical that students at all levels understand AI ethics, including issues of privacy, bias, and accountability. Policies should:
 - Require AI ethics courses as part of both K-12 and higher education curricula.
 - Teach students to recognize and mitigate biases in AI models, ensuring that AI development is equitable and inclusive.
 - Promote discussions on AI's societal impacts, particularly in fields such as healthcare, criminal justice, and labor markets.

By taking these steps, the United States can ensure that AI is used to enhance learning and research without undermining the intellectual skills that drive true innovation. If the AI Action Plan focuses solely on advancing AI technology without equipping students with the critical thinking skills needed to engage with it meaningfully, we risk creating a workforce that depends on AI rather than one that leads it. I strongly urge the administration to prioritize AI education policies that empower students

to harness AI as a tool for discovery, innovation, and critical analysis. By ensuring that AI education is both widespread and intellectually rigorous, we can prepare the next generation to lead in AI development rather than merely follow its advancements. Thank you for considering my perspective. I look forward to seeing policies that support both AI literacy and the cultivation of independent thought across all levels of education with this administration's support. Sincerely,
Raza Ali